



STRATEGIC PLAN 2024-2028

Ethiopia Media Women Association
(EMWA)

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Addis Ababa

Address:

Ethiopia Media Women Association (EMWA)

T: +251 11 111 68 52

+251 11 111 68 62;

F: +251 11 111 68 52

P.O. Box: 6473, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

E-mail: ethiopianMWA@gmail.com

emwa2014@yahoo.com



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BoD	Board of Directors
CSOs	Civil Society Organizations
EEA	Ethiopian Economic Association
EMWA	Ethiopian Media Women Association
EPHA	Ethiopian Public Health Association
FGD	Focus Group Discussion
IGAs	Income Generating Activities
NGOs	Non-governmental Organizations
PESTEL	Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Environmental and Legal
SP	Strategic Plan
SWOT	Strength, Weakness, Opportunities and Threats

Background of Ethiopian Media Women Association

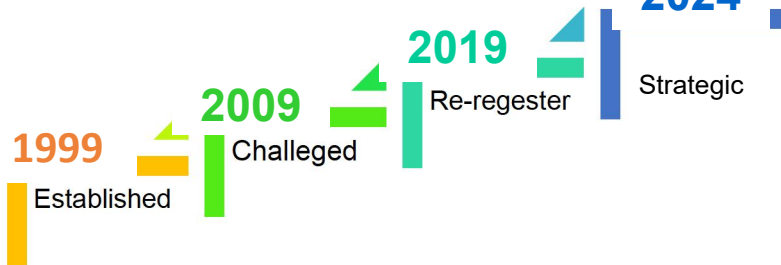
The Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA) is a non-partisan, non-profit civil society association founded by like-minded female journalists and media professionals in 1999.

Since its inception, EMWA has diligently pursued its objectives through the implementation of various projects and programs. Initially, the focus of EMWA was on enhancing the skills of women media professionals, facilitating women's ownership and benefit from alternative and community media, creating gender sensitive media, and improving women's access and participation in the media. In its past endeavors, EMWA also worked on improving the portrayal of women in the media and enhanced their representation in both media and the public's perception.

Formerly a prominent association dedicated to addressing media and women-related issues, EMWA faced challenges following the enactment of the Charities and Societies Proclamation No. 621/2009. This legislation required EMWA to register as an Ethiopian Society and forced it to raise 90% of its income from local sources, where there was high competition for the scarce resources available for charity work in the country and as a result could not generate sufficient fund. Consequently, EMWA experienced a significant reduction in its income sources, leading to the termination of its activities and the cancellation of the contracts of its 18 permanent staff.

However, following the relaxation of CSOs legislation in 2019, EMWA re-registered again and started actively working with various funding agencies on reorganizing the secretariat and capacity building activities for female media practitioners. It is aspiring to expand its activities and fulfil its vision and mission.

Strategic EMWA



Rationale for Strategic Planning

The Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA) had a strategic plan that is currently inactive. However, from 2009 to 2019 the media landscape has changed significantly where many FM radios, satellite televisions, regional media, and community radios flourished in greater number and digital media emerged.

In order to meet the demands and interests of female media professionals, EMWA needs to have a strategic plan that takes the change in the media landscape in to consideration. Consequently, there is a pressing need to formulate a new strategic plan capable of adapting to both internal and external changes. The new strategic plan is designed to achieve the following objectives:

Guidance

Provide clear guidance and direction to the Executive Management and Board for the upcoming five years (2024-2028).

Resource

Facilitate the effective mobilization and allocation of resources towards predetermined goals.

Sustainability

Enable the association to sustainably support its program initiatives.

Direction

Establish a strategic direction that promotes growth and service expansion.

Key Activities of the Planning Process

During the strategic plan preparation, the following activities were performed.

Figure 1: Strategic planning development process



Methodology of the Assignment

The preparation of this strategic plan passed through different data collection methods including review of relevant documents, in depth interview with EMWA members, officers in the secretariat, former and current executive board members, junior media owners and other relevant partners and stakeholders such as media owners and right based organizations. The informants were possessively selected based on their level of engagement and value of information they provide for the purpose of the assignment.

The planning was participatory with the aim of promoting sense of ownership and ensuring proper implementation.

The planning team used the following data gathering approaches and instruments.

1. **Consultative workshops:** a data gathering consultative workshop was conducted with key stakeholders of EMWA,



including previous and existing board members and prominent members.

2. **Focus group discussions (FGDs):** Discussions were held with members and board of EMWA.
3. **In-depth Interview:** In-depth interviews were conducted with key informants relevant to the development of the strategic plan.
4. **Document review:** Pertinent documents such as the previous strategic plan, organizational working documents, progress reports, success stories / challenges, profile of EMWA, bylaw, the current CSO proclamation, and other important documents were reviewed.
5. **Literature review:** Up-to-date strategic management literature was reviewed.
6. **Bench marking:** The experiences of similar local professional associations such as Ethiopian Economic Association (EEA) and Ethiopian Public Health Association (EPHA)) were also consulted by reviewing their websites.

Situational Analysis

This section of the strategic plan document presents a concise overview of the situation analysis, focusing on the internal and external factors influencing EMWA's performance. It encompasses PESTEL, SWOT, Stakeholder, and Sectoral analyses.

PESTEL Analysis

The PESTEL analysis evaluates the socio-economic, political, demographic, technological, and legal aspects in Ethiopia. The CSOs Proclamation implications are reviewed, highlighting opportunities for EMWA to engage in income-generating activities, mobilize funds globally, and recommend changes in the law. The global environment is examined, revealing challenges such as climate change, financial crises, and migration that impact CSOs similar to EMWA. The review emphasizes the need for EMWA to understand and mitigate the effects of these factors to achieve its

objectives in promoting women media professionals' empowerment and active involvement.

SWOT Analysis

In the internal environmental analysis, EMWA's strengths and weaknesses are identified. The organization is noted for its much strength that can be leveraged for future endeavors, but it also has weaknesses that require improvement to streamline services for stakeholders. The analysis, summarized in Table 6 and 7 as attached in Annex 1, serves as a foundation for strategic planning, offering insights into areas for enhancement and optimization.

Stakeholder Analysis

Stakeholder analysis, a crucial aspect of the strategic plan development, is also addressed. Key internal stakeholders, including members, employees, management, and the board of directors, as well as external stakeholders such as donors, partners, and government agencies, are identified. Table 8 of Annex 2 presents a stakeholders matrix outlining their expectations and needs, along with the degree of importance. This comprehensive overview ensures a thorough understanding of the diverse interests involved, facilitating EMWA's strategic planning process to effectively meet stakeholder expectations and contribute to the organization's overarching objectives.

Best Experience from Bench marked Associations

The strategic plan development involves drawing valuable insights from the Ethiopian Public Health Association (EPHA) and the Ethiopian Economic Association (EEA). From EPHA, lessons include a clear and participatory executive board member selection process, the initiation of income generation and building construction projects, a robust secretariat, chapter-based conferences to foster a sense of belonging, awards for outstanding contributions, regular publications, and effective communication through email and online forms. Membership fees are diverse and accommodating various categories of members (members, associate members, company and lifetime).

Similarly, the Ethiopian Economic Association (EEA) provides lessons applicable to EMWA, despite operating in a different sector. Noteworthy practices from EEA include a strong and empowered

secretariat, an excellent executive committee election process, regional conferences for engagement, commitment, and ownership, student involvement, and acceptance of associate members, recognition of academic achievements, income-generating activities, and influencing policy decisions. These lessons underscore the importance of organizational strength, inclusiveness, and diversification of revenue streams for successful strategic planning.

Strategic Plan from 2024-2028



This section outlines a five-year strategic plan for EMWA, encompassing its strategic directions, objectives, goals, and action steps.

Mission, Vision, Core Values and Motto

Mission

Empowering media women through continuous capacity-building, advocate gender equality and equity in media, and driving positive change to improve and advance ethical and secured media sector, contributing to the development of the profession.

Vision

EMWA envisioned seeing a vibrant media profession and media sector that is secured and convenient for women media professionals.

Motto

Empowering women in and through the media!

Values

Integrity: Adherence to ethical principles, honesty, and transparency in every action of the Association.

Solidarity: Unity and mutual support among members

Inclusiveness: Creating an environment that embraces diversity and ensures equal participation

Professionalism: Commitment to high standards, competence, and ethical conduct

Accountability and transparency: Acknowledging responsibility for actions and maintaining openness in decision-making.

Strategic Gap

Following the analysis of the macro, micro and sector level analysis, lessons and experiences from other associations and the review of documents, the following strategic gaps were identified, which serves as a base for the strategic objectives of EMWA for the period of 2024-2028.

The strategic gaps are issues which may undermine the delivery of the mandates of EMWA to its constituency groups. These include the following.

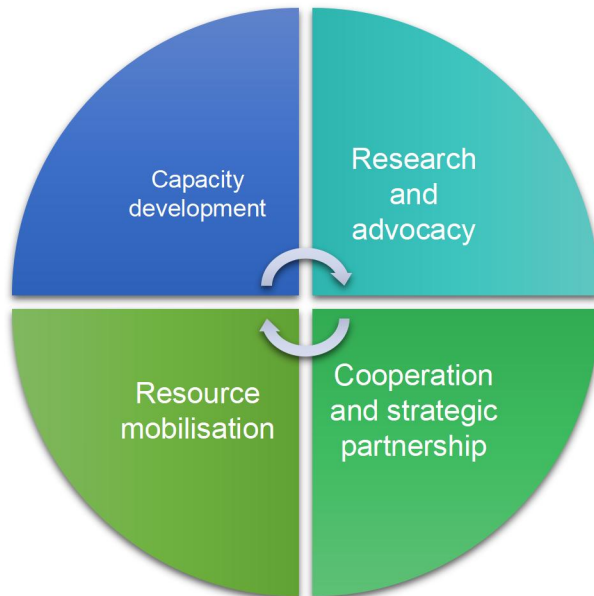
1. **Capacity limitation of the association:** The Association, due to the legal environment of CSOs sector, encountered an existential threat during the period of 2009 to 2019, where there was no permanent staff. Following the relaxation of the legal environment, the association has re-registered and reorganized itself, hired staff and continued its normal activities. However, the association still has limited capacity, that results in failure to:
 - exploit available funding opportunities,
 - utilize members' capacity for its own advantage,
 - take advantage of its existing partnership,
 - work on advocacy to build its visibility.
2. **Lack of sufficient resources:** The limited organizational capacity resulted in the limited operations of the association. For instance, the Association could not be able to hire sufficient

experts who can mobilize sufficient funds that can help to build the capacity of the Association and then implement programs that target its core objectives.

3. **Lack of Strategic focus:** Currently, the association focuses on routine issues and could not get a space to have an influence at policy level. Though the board members are vibrant and committed to the growth of the association, they intervene in the day-to-day activities of the organization. This is failure to exploit the potential of its members to empower the association.

Core Strategic Issues

Based on the data analysis, the following strategic issues or pillars are identified.



Strategic Issue 1: Capacity development

Objective 1: Revise EMWA's bylaw and structure.

Objective 2: Build the capacity of EMWA.

Objective 3: Introduce and implement accountability system.

Objective 4: Build Members' capacity.

Objective 5: Expand membership base.

Objective 6: Improve members' engagement.

Objective 7: Advance members rights and benefits and increase their satisfaction.

Strategic Issue 2: Research and advocacy

Objective 1: Conduct research on gender and media.

Objective 2: Increase EMWA's visibility.

Objective 3: Position EMWA in the media sector.

Strategic Issue 3: Resource mobilization

Objective 1: Diversify the income sources of EMWA.

Objective 2: Strengthen the benefits generated from volunteer services.

Strategic Issue 4: Cooperation and strategic partnership

Objective 1: Create strong network and cooperation with relevant stakeholders.

Table 1: Strategic Issues, objectives and strategies

Strategic Issues	Strategic Objectives	Strategies
Strategic Issue 1: Capacity development EMWA, to achieve its objectives in a sustainable manner, needs to focus on strengthening its internal systems, structures, processes, and people, expand its membership base while retaining the existing and improve performance, efficiency, and impact. EMWA will prioritize revision of its bylaw and organizational structure, building internal capacity for recruiting competent employees, developing instruments to facilitate its activities, and installing system of accountability. Expanding members' base needs a decision on whom to attract and why. To realize this, the association will coordinate its members and partner with various	Objective 1. Revise EMWA's bylaw and structure	Strategic Actions • Revise the association's bylaw and align the organizational structure. • Partner with similar associations and adopt best practices. • Regularly review the effectiveness of the revised bylaw and structure. • Translate the bylaw to English and other local languages
	Objective 2. Build the capacity of EMWA	Strategic Actions • Develop important policies, guidelines and manuals. • Recruit competent and proactive employees. • Improve service provision capacity of EMWA through office facilities and equipment. • Design systems to accommodate

organizations. Therefore, EMWA should strive to meet the following objectives during the planning period.

**Objective 3.
Introduce and
implement
Accountability
System**

various types of members.

- Build the staff capacity.
- Implement an attractive incentive mechanism to motivate employees.

Strategic Actions

- Define Accountability Standards.
- Implement Effective Monitoring and Evaluation measures.
- Establish consequences for non-compliance.
- Promote a culture of accountability.

Strategic Actions

- Develop a strong brand identity in the national and international media coalitions and networks.
- Organize meaningful dialogue and discussion on gender and media issues.
- Advocate for gender-sensitive media, gender related policies

		and strategies in media.
Strategic Issue 2: Expand membership base. <i>Expanding membership base is a continuous activity that attracts new members while retaining the existing. It needs a decision on whom to attract and why. To achieve this, EMWA should strive to meet the following objectives during the planning period.</i>	Objective 1. Increase membership base	Strategic actions • Actively work on recruiting new and retaining existing members. • Develop membership policy. • Strengthen offices in the regions to promote EMWA and recruit new members.
	Objective 2 Improve the members' engagement	Strategic Action • Assess the engagement needs of members. • Implement a system that allows the active participation of all members in Executive Board elections, ensuring a democratic and inclusive decision-making process. • Continuously promote the association's instruments, vision, mission and impacts. • Celebrate milestones and achievements: Recognize

		anniversaries, birthdays, or other significant events to show members they are valued. • Create diverse communication channels to reach members. • Create equal opportunity for members to take responsibility in decision making or voluntary initiatives.
	Objective 3. Advance members' rights and benefits and increase their satisfaction	Strategic Actions • Regularly assess and address the expectations of members. • Negotiate with relevant stakeholders to secure enhanced benefits and security for members. • Listen to and promptly address concerns raised by members, fostering a culture of responsiveness and open communication. • Influence the media sector to enhance the working environment for female media professionals and

		work towards enhancing workplace satisfaction. • Work towards improving professional development opportunities for members. • Advocate and actively work to ensure the rights of members. • Establish an effective and transparent mechanism for members to raise grievances and concerns.
	Objective 2 Build Members' capacity	Strategic actions • Assess members' capacity development needs. • Collaborate with training and knowledge institutions to facilitate capacity building. • Develop capacity building strategy. • Set up important capacity building infrastructure at EMWA. • Provide training, mentoring, and coaching support as well as

		organize exchange programs. • Create access for users of EMWA's knowledge and skills facilities. • Collaborative with junior and senior media professionals to do research. • Meaningfully network with women and media women networks and associations.
Strategic Issue 3: Research and advocacy EMWA is a membership association. Even though it prioritizes members in any of its services, it does not mean that EMWA provides service only to members. As a women and media affiliated association, it primarily focuses on members. But interested service seekers could also benefit from EMWA's works and services as well as support the association. EMWA will provide evidence supported and tailored supports. Towards	Objective 1. Conduct research on gender and media	Strategic Actions: • Undertake multi-stakeholder discussion on gender and media. • Produce learning or policy documents. • Support students to do research on gender and media. • Coordinate public/private partnerships to advance research and increase funding for the sector • Make EMWA a gender and media knowledge hub/excellence center.

this end, EMWA should achieve the following objectives:

Objective 2.
Position EMWA in
the media sector

Strategic actions

- Develop a strong brand identity in the national and international media coalitions and networks.
- Organize meaningful dialogue and discussion on gender and media issues.
- Closely work with the government to advice on gender-sensitive media sector policies and strategies.

Objective 3.
Increase EMWA's
visibility

Strategic actions

- Develop advocacy and visibility strategy.
- Develop Communication Protocols
- Create advocacy and visibility

		capacity at EMWA. • Engage members in advocacy and visibility activities. • Create nonmember ambassador of EMWA. • Conduct awareness sessions. • Regularly communicate the achievements and challenges • Utilize diverse communication channels.
Strategic Issue 3: Resource Mobilization EMWA must have a sustainable income source to realize its mission. This will be achieved through mobilizing resources, implanting various activities, and engaging several partners. All these need a strategic focus and management. EMWA should actively pursue the following objectives.	Objective 1. Diversify the income sources of EMWA	Strategic actions • Collect membership fees effectively. • Explore and implement income-generating initiatives. • Create capacity to develop attractive project proposals. • Organize fundraising events. • Develop donor and partner relationship management strategy.

	Objective 2. Strengthen the benefits generated from volunteer services	Strategic actions • Develop a guideline for staff contribution from EMWA initiated works. • Promote volunteer service by mobilizing members • Arrange modalities to get volunteer service from different segments of society. • Coordinate and arrange a situation for inviting volunteers from abroad
Strategic Issue 4: Cooperation and strategic Partnership Cooperation and strategic partnership are key for the sustainability of EMWA. The association needs a clear strategy to guide its collaboration endeavor. By strategically leveraging these partnerships, EMWA can enhance its collective impact, share resources, and achieve shared objectives that contribute to its overall mission and success.	Objective 1. Create a strong network and cooperation with relevant stakeholders	Strategic actions ▪ Map donors and partners ▪ Develop partnership management instruments. ▪ Organize partners' event. ▪ Equip these partners with relevant information to advocate for and support the cause of EMWA.

Assumptions

The following considerations have been set to effectively implement the results (target) set by the strategic plan.

Internal strategic supportive situations

- The association's management is expected to provide committed leadership for the implementation of the strategic plan.
- The association will change its operating system with a modern and effective operating system.
- The association will change the service provided to the members in a way that is convenient and satisfactory to them.
- The association works closely with its members.
- The association provides adequate training to employees and management.
- The association works closely with relevant stakeholders such as government and media associations.

Financial conditions

- The amount of membership fee to be collected from members will continue to grow.
- The membership base grows every year.
- Reliable and sustainable funding income will be secured.

Breakdown of the Strategic Plan

This part presents the objectives cascaded from strategic pillars, the key performance indicators (**KPIs**), the key result areas of the implementation plan, and the budget required to execute the plan. The detailed breakdown is presented in the following table.

S.N	Strategic issues, objectives and activities	Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)	Baseline	Baseline	Time schedule (years)					Budget (in birr)
					1	2	3	4	5	
1	Strategic Issue 1: Capacity development									
1.1	Objective 1: Revise EMWA's bylaw and structure									
	Strategic Actions: Revise the association's bylaw and structure	Revised bylaw and structure	- BoD - Office	Existing bylaw & structure	X		X			150,000
	Partner with similar associations and adopt best practices	Number of partnerships created	- BoD - Office	2	3	5	5	6	8	Done by staff
	Regularly review the effectiveness of the bylaw and structure	Revised bylaw and structure	- BoD - Office	-	X	X	X	X	X	Done by staff
1.2	Objective 2: Build the capacity of EMWA									

[illegible]

	Strategic Actions: Define Accountability Standards	Standards developed	BoD	None	X		X			Done by Board and management
	Implement Effective Monitoring and Evaluation measures.	M and E system in place	Office		X	X	X	X	X	Done by Staff
	Establish consequences for non-compliance.	System put in place	BoD		X	X	C	X	X	By management
	Promote a culture of accountability		Office		X	X	X	X	X	By the Management
1.4 Objective 4: Position EMWA in the media sector										
	Strategic Actions: Develop a strong brand identity in the national and international media coalitions and networks.	Number of networks	BoD		X	X	X	X	X	Board and Management

	Organize meaningful dialogue and discussion on gender and media issues.	Number of sessions	Office	None	1	3	4	5	5	2,000,000
	Closely work with the government to advise on gender-sensitive media sector policies and strategies	Policies revised to accommodate gender issues	BoD		X	X	X	X	X	Done by staff
2	Strategic Issue 2: Expand membership base									
1.5	Objective 1: Expand membership base									
	Strategic actions: Actively work on recruiting new and retaining existing members.	Number of active members	Membership department	200	220	250	300	350	400	100,000
	Develop membership policy.	Policy document	Membership department	0						50,000
	Strengthen offices in the regions to promote EMWA and recruit new members.	Number of strong and vibrant	Membership department							100,000

		regional offices	ment							
1.6	Objective 2: Improve the members' engagement.									
	Strategic Action: Assess the engagement needs of members.	Need assessment	Membership department	None	X		X			Done by staff
	Implement a system that allows the active participation of all members in Executive Board elections, ensuring a democratic and inclusive decision-making process.	Vibrant election system	BOD & Office	None	X					Done by board and staff
	Continuously promote the association's instruments, vision, mission and impacts.	Active engagement of members and staff	Membership department		X	X	X	X	X	Done by staff
	Celebrate milestones and achievements: Recognize anniversaries, birthdays, or other significant events to show members they are valued.	Number of events	Office and Membership department		X	X	X	X	X	Done by staff

			ment							
	Create diverse communication channels to reach members.	Number of alternative communication channels	Membership department		X		X			Done by management and board
	Create equal opportunity for members to take responsibility in decision-making or voluntary initiatives.	Active participation of members in decision-making	Office		X	X	X	X	X	Done by board and management
1.7	Objective 3: Advance members rights and benefits and increase their satisfaction.									
	Strategic Actions: Regularly assess and address the expectations of members through ongoing surveys, discussions, and dialogues	Surveys and dialogues conducted	Membership management department		X	X	X	X	X	Done by staff

	Negotiate with relevant stakeholders (such as government agencies, and media owners) to secure enhanced benefits and security for members, including improved working conditions, reasonable safety measures, and fair compensations.	Improved conditions of members	BOD and Office		X	X	X	X	X	BODs and management
	Actively work towards changing the role of media professionals in the wider public, promoting a more positive and impactful perception of their contributions	Improved engagement of professionals	- BoD - Office		X	X	X	X	X	Done by staff
	Listen to and promptly address concerns raised by members, fostering a culture of responsiveness and open communication.	Number of grievances handled	Office		X	X	X	X	X	Done by staff

	Influence the media sector to enhance the working environment for professionals, advocating for better conditions and standards	Advocacy work	Office		X	X	X	X	X	2,000,000
	Work towards improving professional development opportunities for members, including access to information, publications, websites, continuing education, short-term training, exchange programs, and participation in research and discussion forums	Number of programs and opportunities created	- BoD - Office		To be decided by the study					200,000
	Advocate and actively work to ensure that the rights of members are not violated, providing a safeguard against any infringements.	Satisfaction of members	Membership department		X	X	X	X	X	Done by staff

	Work towards enhancing workplace satisfaction by advocating clear and transparent rules and regulations for hiring, promotion, and career advancement.	Establishment of rules and regulations	Office	None	1					50,000
	Establish an effective and transparent mechanism for members to raise grievances and concerns, ensuring timely resolution and promoting a culture of fairness.	A clear grievance system in place	Office		X					Done by staff
3	Strategic Issue 3: Research and Advocacy									
1.8	Objective 1: Conduct research on gender, media, and gender and media									
	Strategic Actions: Conduct regular needs assessments.	Need assessment conducted	Office	None		X		X		150,000
	Undertake multi-stakeholder discussion on gender and media.	Number of discussions	Office		X	X	X	X	X	250,000

	Produce learning or policy documents	Number of documents produced	- BoD - Office		1					150,000
	Support students to do research on gender and media.	Number of students supported	Office		30	40	45	50	60	2,000,000
	Coordinate public/private partnerships to advance research and increase funding for the sector,	Sign MoU with partners	BoD	None		X				Done by staff
1.9 Objective 2: Build Members' capacity.										
	Strategic actions: Assess members' capacity development needs	Need assessment conducted	- BoD - Office		1		1			250,000
	Collaborate with training and knowledge institutions to facilitate capacity building	MOU signed with institutions	Office		X	X	X	X	X	Will be done by staff
	Develop capacity building strategy	Capacity development strategy	- BoD - Office		1					50,000
	Provide training, mentoring, and coaching support as well	Number of participants	Office		To be decided based on available					To be decided

	as organize exchange programs.	in various capacity development programs			fund and interested participant					
	Set up important capacity-building infrastructure at EMWA.	Facility put in place	- BoD - Office			X				1,000,000
	Make EMWA a gender and media knowledge hub/excellence center.	Changes Observed	Office		X	X	X	X	X	Done by staff
	Create access for users of EMWA's knowledge and skills facilities.	Number of users who accessed the facilities and knowledge	BoD	None	100	120	130	150	200	Done by staff
	Collaboration with junior media professionals and senior media professionals to do research	Number of collaboration and research works conducted	Office		X	x	x	x	x	Done by staff
	Meaningfully network with women and media women	Number of networks	- BoD - Office		To be decided					Done by staff

	networks and associations	created							
1.1 Objective 3: Increase EMWA's visibility									
	Strategic actions:	• Strategy developed	• BoD	None	1		1		100,000
	• Develop advocacy and visibility strategy								
	• Develop Communication Protocols	• Protocol developed	• Office	None	X				50,000
	• Engage members in advocacy and visibility activities	• Number of members engaged in advocacy	• Office		X	X	X	X	Done by staff
	• Create a non-member ambassador of EMWA	• Number of ambassadors	• Office	0	2	5	7	10	Done by staff
	• Conduct Awareness sessions	• Number of awareness-raising sessions	• Office		X	X	X	X	Done by staff
	• Regularly communicate the achievements and challenges	• Regular communication	• Office		X	X	X	X	Done by the staff

	Strategic actions: Develop a guideline for staff contribution from EMWA initiated works	Guideline developed	Office	None	1					50,000
	Promote volunteer service by mobilizing members of the Association	Number of members who engaged in volunteer activities	Office		20	25	35	40	50	Done by staff
	Develop modalities to get volunteer service from different segments of society	Volunteer modalities developed	Office	None	1		1			Done by staff
	Coordinate and arrange a situation for inviting volunteers from abroad	Number of volunteers participated	- BoD - Office		X	X	X	X	X	Done by staff
4	Strategic Issue 4: Cooperation and strategic Partnership									
4.1	Objective 1: Create a strong network and cooperation with relevant stakeholders									
	Strategic actions: Map donors and partners	Donors and partners map	Office	Existin g donors	X		X			Done by staff

	Develop partnership management instruments	Partnership instruments	Office	None	X					50,000
	Organize partners' event	Number of events	- BoD - Office		X	X	X	X	X	2,000,000
	Equip partners with relevant information to advocate for and support the cause of EMWA	Information dissemination	Office		X	X	X	X	X	Done by staff

Note:

1. The budget amount required for each activity may change with the size and scope of the work, but because of the current dynamic market behavior, it is difficult to set it correctly in advance.
2. Under the responsible column, "the office" refers to the secretariat office and the responsible departments such as program department.
3. Done by staff/ management/ board means the activity will be implemented within the current annual budget without the need for a separate budget.
4. The volume of activities of some strategies will be decided by study and the budget also varies accordingly.
5. The 'X' mark shows the year in which a particular activity will be accomplished. However, in the amount of activities / participants / volume of work outcome are not indicated. The number or volume of outputs/outcomes will be decided in each annual operational plan.
6. As indicated in the matrix strong action must be taken in the first year of implementation of the strategic plan (2024).

Organizational Structure

The implementation of the strategic plan requires an organizational structure consistent with the demands of the strategic directions. Accordingly, and based on the review results of the current organizational structure and the envisioned plan, the strategic planning team proposed the following structure and staffing plan. However, it is not mandatory for EMWA to staff all the positions at the beginning of the strategic period. It can do it gradually when resources are available, and the actual work demands additional staff. This will be decided by the executive director in consultation with the board of directors.

S.N	Position	Number of Staff
1.	Executive Director (ED) Office	
1.1.	Executive Director	1
1.2.	Internal Auditor	1
1.3.	Legal advisor	1
1.4.	Assistant to the executive director	1
1.5.	Research and Visibility Officer	1
	Total	5
2.	Program Management Department	
2.1.	Program Management Manager	1
2.2.	Project officers	2
2.3.	M and E officer	1
2.4.	Ethics & media legal issues officer	1
2.5.	Networking & partnership officer	1
3.	Finance and Admin Department	
3.1.	Finance and Administration Manager	1
3.2.	Finance officer(s)	2
3.3.	Cashier	1

3.4.	HR & Administration Officer	1
4.	Membership Management Department	
4.1.	Membership Management Manager	1
4.2.	Members affairs Officer	1
4.3.	IT and members database Officer	1
5.	Resource Mobilization Department	
5.1.	Resource Mobilization manager	1
5.2.	IGA Officer	1
5.3.	Grant and Donors Management	1
6.	Regional Coordination Office	1
6.1.	Regional Office coordinator	1
6.2.	Regional Offices expert (s)	1
	Total	25

Budget and Source of Finance

This strategic plan assumes that the Association will generate its budget from the following sources:

1. Membership fee
2. Grants/donations
3. Covered by encouraging voluntary services, and
4. Income-generating activities (IGAs).

The total budget required is subject to change as some of the activities are not yet decided. Moreover, the inflation will affect the budget. Therefore, it should be decided while preparing each annual operational plan.

Monitoring and Evaluation and Risks Identification and Mitigation Plan

Monitoring and Evaluation Strategy

To have a successful implementation of the strategic plan of EMWA, there is a need for a rigorous approach and an intensive effort among the board and the executive bodies of the Association.

The implementation of the strategic plan of EMWA may face various challenges due to reasons originating from inside and outside the association. Lack of resources, lack of understanding of the association's vision, lack of skills and knowledge, etc. are the internal challenges of the association that affect the implementation of the strategic plan, while the challenges arising from the political, economic, cultural, social, technological, and legal environment of the country are the other external challenges that affect the implementation of the strategic plan.

Therefore, during the implementation process, the parameters of the plan's success may rise and fall depending on the actual conditions. The following table provides a framework for the association to monitor and evaluate the implementation of the plan while monitoring these changes.

Table 4: Monitoring and Evaluation plan and schedule

S.N.	Major Issue	Explanation	Responsible party
1.	Monitoring and evaluation	Overall plan performance review (quarterly, half yearly and annual) and performance monitoring schedule is prepared and carried out according to the	- Board - Secretariat Office - Departments

		set schedule. - Based on this strategic plan, each department's annual plans and performance are evaluated to match the association's strategic vision, goals, and objectives. - Changes and improvements are made as needed based on the results of monitoring and evaluation	
2.	M and E Schedule	Weekly - at the level of the work units of the Association Monthly - at the level of the association's manager Quarterly and semi-annually - at the level of the management board of the Association Annual - at the level of the general meeting of the association Mid evaluation - the management and board of directors	- Board - Secretariat Office - Departments

Risks and Mitigation Mechanisms

During the implementation of the strategic plan, some barriers are expected. These prevalent risks need to be considered and measures should be taken ahead of time to reduce their impact to an acceptable level. Therefore, the risk management of this strategic plan is considered to take precautionary measures in good time and thus prevent failure of the implementation of the strategic plan. In general, the major risks and mitigation plans that are anticipated in the strategic plan implementation processes are shown *below*:

Table 5: Potential Risk and Mitigation Strategies

S. N.	Potential Risks	Mitigation strategies	Implementors
1.	Limited implementation capacity of staff	- Provide capacity-building training. - Hire competent and sufficient number of staff. - Strong follow up	The Secretariat Office and BoD
2.	Lack of sufficient fund	- Collect membership fees properly. - Diversify the source of income of the association such IGAs - Identify and work with strategic funding agencies - Use the free service of the members under the voluntary service scheme to undertake some activities without the need to spend money	Program department and Executive director
3.	The attitude of non-active members towards EMWA	- Revise the association's bylaws in the shortest time possible and include members' rights and benefits. - Work on advocacy and relationship management and build its image.	The Secretariat Office
4.	Limited awareness about the strategic plan, its relevance, and implementation capacity at all levels in the association	- Conduct workshops to raise awareness about the strategic plan, with a specific focus on EMWA's five-year strategic plan - Familiarize key stakeholders with the details of the strategic plan - Identify significant skill gaps and provide targeted training to enhance the capabilities and knowledge of staff directly or indirectly involved in implementing the strategic plan.	The Office and BoD

Annex 1: Strength and Weakness of EMWA

Table 6: SWOT analysis Result of EMWA

Environmental Factors	Strengths	Weakness
Governance & management system	• Presence of committed board of directors and executive management that ensure check and balance. • Presence of working system and manuals • Presence of annual and strategic plans • Presence of yearly financial audit practices • Valuable service provided to its members	• Lack of diversified board members in terms of expertise • Highly involvement of boards on day-to-day activities • Absence of advisory board • Vision and mission statements are not updated to reflect the current situation • The management of the secretariat is new • Poor record documentation • Outdated manuals, strategies and promotional materials • Limited external communication such as with donors and partner organizations.
Human Resource	• The existence of young and committed staff	• Small number of permanent staff • Lack of experience of existing staff

Financial Resource	• Efficient and transparent utilization of the available financial resource • High potential for raising financial resources from donors	• Less access of adequate and dependable financial resources • Dependency on members fee and limited donor fund • Nonexistence of financial manual and policy
Office facilities	• Adequate office equipment (fixed assets) and facilities (for studio set up) • Has resource center and space for studio • Relatively stable office with least rent cost	• It is rented and can be taken any time.
Technology and Information system	• Have a website and other social media platforms (Facebook, telegram)	• Lack active presence on social media platform. • Lack of updated and functional website
Reputation and Image of EMWA	• Sustainability of the organization through years • EMWA's reputation in the media industry • Has a good relationship with stakeholders (such as CSOs,	• Inadequate promotion of the activities resulting in poor visibility to the potential users of the services of the association and partners • In many cases, the association is leveled as only gender organization by ignoring the

	- government agencies) - EMWA is the only association working on media and gender components in Ethiopia	profession
Members	- Most members are knowledgeable and skillful - Create an opportunity for young undergraduate journalists through internship	- Small volunteer base and limited participation in the activities of the association - Less engagement with members - Failure to utilize members as resources or connecting to resources
Project and program implementation	- Good experience in implementation of projects related to media and women. - It is the only organization that works on the intersection of gender and media in Ethiopia - Proven experience in managing projects in a cost-effective way - Play a major role in representing media women during policy formulation and implementation.	- The limited scope of the projects due to financial capacity limitations - Failure to see new program focus areas (such as conflicts, human rights, harassment) - Lack of innovation in search of donor fund

Annex 2: Strength and Weakness of EMWA

Table 7: Opportunities and Threats

Environment	Opportunity	Threat
Political Environment	• Availability of responsible government agency to deal with issues of women and media	• Recurrent internal conflict adversely affects the commitment of international donors, which may also challenge the resource mobilization effort of the Association. • If the conflict is prolonged for some time in the future, it may affect the project implementation of the Association. • Gender issue is dropped during conflict and other issues are given priority
Economic Environment	• The growth of the economy, which contributed to increasing number of media houses that resulted better employment opportunities for women. • The growth of the economy stimulate self-employment for media women (facilitates engagement in	• A high inflation rate significantly affects the purchasing power of the available funds • The country focuses on a relief economy instead of a growing economy as millions of people are in need of humanitarian needs either due to climate change or displacement due to the political unrest and war • The war in different parts of the country

	- IGAs), increase members base - The growth of economy and employment opportunities of women in the media can increase member-base and mobilize resources from members	destroyed key economic sectors
Socio-Cultural Environment	- Growing awareness in the society about gender equality - Growing attention for the importance of conducive environments for women - Acceptance of women in media activities traditionally left for men and leadership participation	Levelling EMWA as a gender organization and ignoring the profession
Technological environment	- The expansion of Science and Technology, online knowledge centres improve access to education to media women - It facilitates the work, movement, communication opportunities for women	- Limited capacity in using latest technology - Many technologies, including ICT, are expensive and are not easily accessible
Legal & political	Revision of the previous stringent civil society law	The current internal conflict may reduce the financial support from international donors.

environment	• The government gives attention to women in its policies and regulations	• There are gaps in some laws. • There is limited capacity and lack of awareness in implementing the existing laws and regulations. As a result, there are still violations of the rights of media women. • Less freedom in the media sector • Lack of adequate protection on journalists' safety and security
Partners and donors	• Existence of large number of organizations, local and international, who are partners and want to form partnership with EMWA. • Availability of capacity development opportunities through training	• Failure to take advantage of existing partnerships • Failure to utilize available funding opportunities •

Table 8: Stakeholder Analysis Matrix of EMWA

<i>Stakeholders</i>	<i>Stakeholder Expectations /needs</i>	<i>Degree of Importance</i>	<i>EMWA Expectation from Stakeholders</i>
1. Members	• Sustainable and need based projects and programs. • Meaningful participation & decision making • Advocates of rights and freedom • Continuous capacity building (technical and material) • Transparency and accountability • Advocate legal protection • Job opportunities	High	• Active participation and volunteerism • Genuine and realistic feedback on the operation of EMWA • Sense of ownership • Contribution to projects (labour, in kind, financial) • Promote the vision, mission and core values of EMWA • Pay their membership fee • Attract new members
2. Media houses	• Legality • Create a continuous capacity building • Bridging between distorting media bubbles • Promoting media literacy • Transparency & accountability • Enabling participation	High	• Commitment and active participation with societal focus • Promoting the vision, mission and core values of EMWA • Transparent • Trustworthiness

	• Educate media people in terms of civic literacy. • Helping to build professionalism, standards, and strengths of media professionals		
3. Government Agencies	• Legality • Observing the new CSO legislation • Project agreements • Periodic plan standard report • Timely and responsive monitoring and evaluation • Transparency and accountability • Need based and gap-filling projects	High	• Facilitate conducive legal and policy environment • Cooperation and positive response • Prompt feedback on reports • Technical support
4. Donors	• Legality and organizational capacity • Sound project proposal and plan • Accountability and transparency • Adherence to CSOs code of conduct • Quality and timely report • Timely and responsive monitoring and evaluation • Strong partnership	High	• Allocation of adequate budget for projects • Timely budget release • A partnership based on equal footing • Technical support and capacity building • Proper and timely exchange of information • Transparency

			Flexibility
5. Peer Associations	- Network and linkage - Exchange of experience and information - Sharing resources - Avoidance in duplication of efforts - Voicing common concerns jointly	Average	- Willingness to work together - Positive response to requests of EMWA - Information exchange in relevant areas in due times
6. Board of directors	- Committed and skilled executive management - Periodic meeting and updated information exchange - Strong network with stakeholders and partners - Transparency and accountability - Maximize the service provision for media women. - Respect of the relevant legal frameworks - Efficient and effective utilization of	High	- Active involvement in internal and external affairs of the organization - Support the fund-raising initiative of the Association - Timely approval of plans and reports - Establish networks and partnerships with donors and partners - Periodically meet and make decisions

	- funds - Timely and quality report		
7. EMWA'S management group	- Autonomy in decision making - Career advancement - Conducive work environment - Empowerment - Sufficient budget allocation - Sustainable growth and expansion of services to diversified geographic areas	High	- Honesty and integrity - Commitment and competency - Sense of ownership - Respect beneficiaries and employees - Reactiveness - Representing the organization - Promoting the vision, mission, objectives, and core values
8. EMWA'S staff	- Conducive working environment that promotes organizational learning as well as personal growth - Involvement in decision making - Access to communication facilities and system - Capacity building and empowerment - Attractive benefit packages - Fair distribution of responsibilities - Responsive leadership - Effective Performance appraisal - Job security	High	- Representing the organization - Internalizing and publicizing vision, mission, objectives and core values of EMWA - Generating sufficient budget - Commitment - Efficient and effective program implementation - Competency - Sense of ownership - Respect beneficiaries and colleagues

Annex 3: Data Collection Tools**Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA)****Stakeholders' Consultative Workshop for Strategic Planning of
EMWA****A. Matrices and guidelines to facilitate data collection.**

1. SWOT Analysis Matrix – Strengths & weaknesses

	Possible indicators	Strengths	Weaknesses	Ways to overcome weaknesses
Internal	1. Leadership & Governance (Vision, Resource mobilization & management, system, culture & structure, etc.)			
	2. Human Resources (Availability, competence, professionalism, discipline, commitment, Composition etc.)			
	3. Technology (Information system, automation & digitalisation, etc.)			
	4. Financial Management (Revenue generation, cost efficiency, profitability, cash flow & liquidity, financial control, etc.)			
	5. Marketing & Communication (customer service, communication system, etc.)			
	6. Service delivery (Service design, facilities, Capacity, quality, service mix, efficiency, etc.)			

SWOT Analysis Matrix – Opportunity & threats

	Possible indicators	Opportunities	Threats	Ways to overcome threats
External	Political environment (<i>Stability, support, inclusiveness, fairness, etc.</i>)			
	Economic factors (<i>Growth and sustainability, purchasing power, inflation, investment, credit, etc.</i>)			
	Social (<i>Culture, Demography, Lifestyle, work culture, labour etc.</i>)			
	Technology (<i>innovation, access, cost/affordability, risks, competitive advantage</i>)			
	Legal (<i>policies, regulation, enforcement, flexibility</i>)			

2. Stakeholders Mapping Tool

No	Stakeholders	Stakeholder Expectations/needs	Association's Expectations /needs	Ways of meeting needs
1.	Association's members			
2.	Management of the Association (Board, ED)			
3.	Employees of the association			
4.	Government Regulators			
5.	Donors (List different categories if any)			
6.	Partners + Collaborators			
7.	Suppliers Technology, Input			
8.				

3. EMWA Strategic Vision, Mission, Values, & Goals

Existing	Proposed
1. Vision: To envisage the existence of a vibrant professional association capable of creating professionally skilled, educated, and confident Ethiopian female journalist who can bring a difference both nationally and internationally. 2. Mission: Increasing the engagement of Ethiopian female journalists and media practitioners in areas of advocacy, capacity building, and managerial positions in the Ethiopian media. 3. Values: - Participation and Engagement - Faithfulness - Accountability - Transparency - Impartiality - Professional Ethics - Fairness and equity - Endurance - Efficiency and effectiveness - Gender equity 4. Strategic Themes/Issues ✧ Capacity building for member journalists and media practitioners. ✧ Develop guidelines and resources on gender and media issues. ✧ Soliciting scholarships for members. ✧ Conduct research, and studies on female media practitioners. ✧ Advance professional freedom, excellence, and ethical conduct among its members. ✧ Create networks with national and international media houses, women professional organizations and other organizations working with / for women. 5. Strategic Goals /Objective ✧ Raise and empower members professional skills. ✧ Increase members access and participation in the media. ✧ Support members and women in general to own and benefit from alternative community media. ✧ Enhance members' economic and social benefits. ✧ Conduct research on women economic and social participation in relation to media. ✧ Encourage interested women to join the media profession.	1. Vision 2. Mission 3. Core Values 4. Strategic Themes/Issues 5. Strategic Objectives

4. Strategic Pillars (Issues) for EMWA

🌀 Please identify the strategic issues/pillars that EMWA should focus on in the coming five years. Use the following matrix.

No.	Strategic pillar (Issue)	Specific Issues to Address
1.		•
2.		•
3.		•
4.		•
5.		•

🔗 Under each strategic pillar, please identify the following: *Strategic objectives and activities/actions to be taken.*

[illegible]

Table 8: Stakeholder Analysis Matrix of EMWA

Stakeholders	Stakeholder Expectations /needs	Degree of Importance	EMWA Expectation from Stakeholders
9. Members	• Sustainable and need based projects and programs. • Meaningful participation & decision making • Advocates of rights and freedom • Continuous capacity building (technical and material) • Transparency and accountability • Advocate legal protection • Job opportunities	High	• Active participation and volunteerism • Genuine and realistic feedback on the operation of EMWA • Sense of ownership • Contribution to projects (labour, in kind, financial) • Promote the vision, mission and core values of EMWA • Pay their membership fee • Attract new members
10. Media houses	• Legality • Create a continuous capacity building • Bridging between distorting media bubbles • Promoting media literacy • Transparency & accountability • Enabling participation • Educate media people in terms of civic literacy. • Helping to build professionalism, standards, and strengths of media professionals	High	• Commitment and active participation with societal focus • Promoting the vision, mission and core values of EMWA • Transparent • Trustworthiness
11. Government Agencies	• Legality • Observing the new CSO legislation • Project agreements • Periodic plan standard report • Timely and responsive monitoring and evaluation • Transparency and accountability • Need based and gap-filling projects	High	• Facilitate conducive legal and policy environment • Cooperation and positive response • Prompt feedback on reports • Technical support
12. Donors	• Legality and organizational capacity • Sound project proposal and plan • Accountability and transparency • Adherence to CSOs code of conduct • Quality and timely report • Timely and responsive monitoring and evaluation • Strong partnership	High	• Allocation of adequate budget for projects • Timely budget release • A partnership based on equal footing • Technical support and capacity building • Proper and timely exchange of information • Transparency • Flexibility
13. Peer Associations	• Network and linkage • Exchange of experience and information • Sharing resources • Avoidance in duplication of efforts • Voicing common concerns jointly	Average	• Willingness to work together • Positive response to requests of EMWA • Information exchange in relevant areas in due times

14. Board of directors	• Committed and skilled executive management • Periodic meeting and updated information exchange • Strong network with stakeholders and partners • Transparency and accountability • Maximize the service provision for media women. • Respect of the relevant legal frameworks • Efficient and effective utilization of funds • Timely and quality report	High	• Active involvement in internal and external affairs of the organization • Support the fund-raising initiative of the Association • Timely approval of plans and reports • Establish networks and partnerships with donors and partners • Periodically meet and make decisions
15. EMWA'S management group	• Autonomy in decision making • Career advancement • Conducive work environment • Empowerment • Sufficient budget allocation • Sustainable growth and expansion of services to diversified geographic areas	High	• Honesty and integrity • Commitment and competency • Sense of ownership • Respect beneficiaries and employees • Reactiveness • Representing the organization • Promoting the vision, mission, objectives, and core values
16. EMWA'S staff	• Conducive working environment that promotes organizational learning as well as personal growth • Involvement in decision making • Access to communication facilities and system • Capacity building and empowerment • Attractive benefit packages • Fair distribution of responsibilities • Responsive leadership • Effective Performance appraisal • Job security	High	• Representing the organization • Internalizing and publicizing vision, mission, objectives and core values of EMWA • Generating sufficient budget • Commitment • Efficient and effective program implementation • Competency • Sense of ownership • Respect beneficiaries and colleagues

Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA)
Stakeholders' Consultative Workshop for Strategic Planning of EMWA

B. Matrices and guidelines to facilitate data collection.

5. SWOT Analysis Matrix – Strengths & weaknesses

	Possible indicators	Strengths	Weaknesses	Ways to overcome weaknesses
Internal	7. <u>Leadership & Governance</u> (<i>Vision, Resource mobilization & management, system, culture & structure, etc.</i>)			
	8. <u>Human Resources</u> • (<i>Availability, competence, professionalism, discipline, commitment, Composition etc.</i>)			
	9. <u>Technology</u> • (<i>Information system, automation & digitalisation, etc.</i>)			
	10. <u>Financial Management</u> • (<i>Revenue generation, cost efficiency, profitability, cash flow & liquidity, financial control, etc.</i>)			
	11. <u>Marketing & Communication</u> • (<i>customer service, communication system, etc.</i>)			
	12. <u>Service delivery</u> (<i>Service design, facilities, Capacity, quality, service mix, efficiency, etc.</i>)			

SWOT Analysis Matrix – Opportunity & threats

	Possible indicators	Opportunities	Threats	Ways to overcome threats
External	Political environment (<i>Stability, support, inclusiveness, fairness, etc.</i>)			
	Economic factors (<i>Growth and sustainability, purchasing power, inflation, investment, credit, etc.</i>)			
	Social (<i>Culture, Demography, Lifestyle, work culture, labour etc.</i>)			
	Technology (<i>innovation, access, cost/affordability, risks, competitive advantage</i>)			
	Legal (<i>policies, regulation, enforcement, flexibility</i>)			

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No	Stakeholders	Stakeholder Expectations/needs	Association's Expectations /needs	Ways of meeting needs
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12.	Government Regulators			
13.	Donors (List different categories if any)			
14.	Partners + Collaborators			
15.	Suppliers Technology, Input			
16.				

7. EMWA Strategic Vision, Mission, Values, & Goals

Existing	Proposed
6. <u>Vision:</u> To envisage the existence of a vibrant professional association capable of creating professionally skilled, educated, and confident Ethiopian female journalist who can bring a difference both nationally and internationally. 7. <u>Mission:</u> Increasing the engagement of Ethiopian female journalists and media practitioners in areas of advocacy, capacity building, and managerial positions in the Ethiopian media. 8. <u>Values:</u> - Participation and Engagement - Faithfulness - Accountability - Transparency - Impartiality - Professional Ethics - Fairness and equity - Endurance - Efficiency and effectiveness - Gender equity 9. <u>Strategic Themes/Issues</u> ✧ Capacity building for member journalists and media practitioners. ✧ Develop guidelines and resources on gender and media issues. ✧ Soliciting scholarships for members. ✧ Conduct research, and studies on female media practitioners. ✧ Advance professional freedom, excellence, and ethical conduct among its members. ✧ Create networks with national and international media houses, women professional organizations and other organizations working with / for women. 10. <u>Strategic Goals /Objective</u> ✧ Raise and empower members professional skills. ✧ Increase members access and participation in the media. ✧ Support members and women in general to own and benefit from alternative community media. ✧ Enhance members' economic and social benefits. ✧ Conduct research on women economic and social participation in relation to media. ✧ Encourage interested women to join the media profession.	6. <u>Vision:</u> 7. <u>Mission:</u> 8. <u>Core Values</u> 9. <u>Strategic Themes/Issues</u> 10. <u>Strategic Objectives</u>

8. Strategic Pillars (Issues) for EMWA

- ✧ Please identify the strategic issues/pillars that EMWA should focus on in the coming five years. Use the following matrix.

No.	Strategic pillar (Issue)	Specific Issues to Address
6.		•
7.		•
8.		•
9.		•
10.		•

- ✧ Under each strategic pillar, please identify the following: *Strategic objectives and activities/actions to be taken.*

[illegible]

